

How Can I Contribute to Mozilla?

Open source software depends upon the contributions made by thousands of people in the community who help to improve and modify it. These contributions are not merely monetary, but also in the form of feedback and improvements to the software, particularly in ironing out bugs. This is a vital service that keeps the spirit of the FOSS movement alive today.



mozilla
Firefox

Mozilla is one of the leading open source organisations in the world. A lot of people work for Mozilla, fixing bugs and implementing new features. Since people use various platforms for this, here's a small guide to installing the source code for Mozilla on different platforms and on how you can begin with your first contributions. As an open source contributor, I believe that Mozilla is one of the best OSS projects to start off with when you want to give back to the community.

Hardware requirements

While installing Mozilla source code, the first thing to do is to install its dependencies. The minimum hardware requirements are:

- 2 GB RAM and lots of free space in it
- For debugging and builds: At least 8 GB of free space
- For optimised builds: At least 1 GB of free space (recommended 6 GB)

Build tools and dependencies

All distros require just a one-line 'bootstrap' command

This is the best way to install the dependencies, irrespective of the distro you are using. For this, open a terminal and copy paste the following commands:

```
wget https://hg.mozilla.org/mozilla-central/raw-file/default/python/mozboot/bin/bootstrap.py
python bootstrap.py
```

If the above command doesn't work then proceed with one of the following, based on the OS you are using.

Ubuntu

Download and install the prerequisites required for the Mozilla build in Ubuntu (as root), as follows:

```
sudo apt-get install zip unzip mercurial g++ make
autoconf2.13 yasm libgtk2.0-dev libglib2.0-dev libdbus-1-
dev libdbus-glib-1-dev libasound2-dev libcurl4-openssl-dev
libxi-dev libxt-dev mesa-common-dev libgstreamer0.10-
dev libgstreamer-plugins-base0.10-dev libpulse-dev
```

Debian

Install the prerequisites required for the Mozilla build in Debian (as root) by running the following:

```
sudo aptitude install zip unzip mercurial g++ make
autoconf2.13 yasm libgtk2.0-dev libglib2.0-dev libdbus-1-
dev libdbus-glib-1-dev libasound2-dev libcurl4-openssl-dev
libxi-dev libxt-dev mesa-common-dev libgstreamer0.10-
dev libgstreamer-plugins-base0.10-dev libpulse-dev
```

Debian Squeeze Edition

On Debian Squeeze, you need to install `yasm-1.x` from the Squeeze backports. You can also get the Mercurial bundle if you need compatibility with an existing Mercurial repository:

```
echo "deb http://backports.debian.org/debian-backports
squeeze-backports main" >> /etc/apt/sources.list
aptitude update
aptitude -t squeeze-backports install yasm mercurial
```

OpenSUSE and SUSE Linux Enterprise

To install the dependencies in OpenSUSE, execute the